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PREMIUM NOTES

UPSC — History Notes

UPSC Test Series — StuDy

High-yield facts, formulas and trap-radar — made for the real exam hall.

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UPSC — History Notes

Ancient — Concepts UPSC Tests

- Neolithic: first food producers; Burzahom (Kashmir — pit dwellings), Chirand (Bihar — bone tools). Chalcolithic cultures: Ahar (Rajasthan), Jorwe (Maharashtra), Kayatha (MP).
- Harappan: town planning (grid, drainage, burnt bricks 1:2:4 ratio), weights in binary/decimal multiples, script undeciphered (pictographic, right-to-left boustrophedon), no temples identified; Priest-King (steatite), Dancing Girl (bronze, lost-wax), Great Bath (ritual bathing). Cotton was first produced here (Greek 'Sindon').
- Later Vedic: iron (krishna ayas), PGW culture, first territorial states (janapadas → 16 Mahajanapadas; capitals: Magadha—Rajgriha/Pataliputra, Kosala—Shravasti, Vatsa—Kaushambi, Avanti—Ujjain). Ajatashatru built Pataliputra fort; Bimbisara (Haryanka) contemporary of Buddha & Mahavira.
- Ashokan edicts: Major Rock Edict XIII (Kalinga + dhamma), Pillars (polished sandstone, Lauriya Nandangarh lion), Rummindei pillar (Lumbini, tax reduced to 1/8). Scripts: Brahmi (left→right), Kharoshthi (right→left, NW), Greek/Aramaic in Afghanistan.
- Post-Mauryan: Indo-Greeks (Menander/Milinda — Milindapanho), Shakas (Rudradaman — Junagadh inscription, first long Sanskrit inscription; Sudarshana lake repairs), Kushanas (Kanishka — 78 CE Shaka era, 4th Buddhist council, Gandhara & Mathura art, silk route). Satavahanas (first land grants to Brahmanas — epigraphic evidence; lead coins, Amaravati art).
- Gupta & after: land grant economy debate (feudalism — R.S. Sharma), temple architecture begins (Dashavatara Deogarh), zero & decimal (Aryabhata), court poet Harisena. Sangam literature: Tolkappiyam (grammar), Silappadikaram (Ilango Adigal), Manimekalai; three Sangams at Madurai; Chera (bow), Chola (tiger), Pandya (fish) emblems.

Medieval — State, Economy, Culture

- Delhi Sultanate administration: Iqta system (revenue assignment, systematised by Iltutmish, reformed by Balban/Alauddin), Khalisa (crown land), Diwan-i-Arz (military, Alauddin), token currency experiment (MBT, 1329–30, failed), Daulatabad shift (1327).
- Bhakti regional forms: Maharashtra (Varkari — Jnaneshwar, Namdev, Tukaram; Pandharpur), Assam (Ekasharana — Srimanta Sankardeva), Bengal (Chaitanya — Gaudiya Vaishnavism), Karnataka (Virashaiva/Lingayat — Basava, Vachana literature). Alvars (Vaishnava) & Nayanars (Shaiva) — Tamil bhakti, 6th–9th c.
- Mughal systems: Mansabdari (zat = personal rank/pay; sawar = cavalry contingent), Zabt (measurement-based revenue — Todar Mal, Ain-i-Dahsala), Jagir (transferable) vs Inam; Ain-i-Akbari by Abul Fazl (Akbar Nama 3rd part). Painting: Humayun brought Persian masters; Jahangir era naturalism peak (Ustad Mansur).
- Architecture lines: Qutub complex (Delhi), Alai Darwaza (first true dome/arch — Alauddin), Tughlaqabad (massive sloping walls), Sher Shah's tomb (Sasaram, lake), Fatehpur Sikri (Buland Darwaza), Itimad-ud-Daulah (first pietra dura, all-marble — Jahangir era), Taj (1632–53, Ustad Ahmad Lahauri tradition).
- Vijayanagara: four dynasties (Sangama, Saluva, Tuluva, Aravidu); Krishnadeva Raya's Amuktamalyada (Telugu); Hazara Rama & Vittala temples (musical pillars); foreign travellers — Nicolo Conti, Abdur Razzaq, Domingo Paes, Nuniz.

Modern — Movements & Constitutional Development

- Peasant/tribal movements: Indigo (1859–60 Bengal), Pabna (1873), Deccan Riots (1875), Champaran/Kheda, Bardoli (1928 — Patel got 'Sardar'), Tebhaga (1946 Bengal), Telangana (1946–51). Tribal: Santhal Hul (1855 — Sidhu-Kanhu), Munda Ulgulan (1899–1900 — Birsa), Kol (1831), Rampa (1922 — Alluri Sitarama Raju).
- Press & education: first newspaper Bengal Gazette (1780, Hicky); Vernacular Press Act 1878 (Lytton, repealed by Ripon); Wood's Despatch 1854 ('Magna Carta of English education'); Hunter Commission 1882; Universities 1857 (Calcutta, Bombay, Madras).
- Constitutional acts ladder: 1773 (GG of Bengal, SC at Calcutta) → 1784 Pitt's (dual control) → 1813 (trade monopoly ends, ₹1 lakh education) → 1833 (GG of India — Bentinck first; law commission — Macaulay) → 1853 (open competition principle) → 1858 (Crown rule, Secretary of State) → 1861 (portfolio system begins) → 1892 (indirect election element) → 1909 (separate electorates) → 1919 (dyarchy in provinces, bicameral centre) → 1935 (provincial autonomy, dyarchy at centre proposed, RBI & Federal Court under it).
- Partition & transfer: Wavell Plan & Simla Conference 1945; Cabinet Mission 1946 (grouping scheme); Interim Government (Nehru as VP, Sept 1946); Mountbatten Plan (3 June 1947); Radcliffe Award (boundaries); integration of princely states — Patel + V.P. Menon; holdouts: Junagadh (plebiscite), Hyderabad (Operation Polo, Sept 1948), Kashmir (accession 26 Oct 1947).
- Post-1947 integration: States Reorganisation — Fazl Ali Commission; SRC Act 1956 (14 states, 6 UTs); first linguistic state Andhra (1953, after Potti Sriramulu). Goa liberated 1961 (Operation Vijay); Sikkim 1975 (36th Amd — full state).

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